

Your Job Simulation — The Complete Answer Sheet

Contents

1. What company runs this? (asymmetry, removed)
2. The monitoring and anti-cheating measures — all of them
3. The camera question — yes, look at the lens
4. How your video answers are actually assessed
5. How to pass — the strategy, condensed to one page
6. Your 4-day runbook

The library (what each document covers)

Source list (condensed — full lists in the library documents)

For: Janak · **Prepared:** 16 August 2026 · **Purpose:** every question from your invite answered in one place, condensed from the full research library (each section points to the detailed document behind it).

⚠ **Read this first: your deadline.** Your invite arrived **10 August** with a **10-day window** — so it expires around **20 August, roughly 4 days from now**. Recommended plan: final rehearsal today or tomorrow, **sit the assessment the day after, mid-morning, fresh** — keeping at least one buffer day in case of technical problems (genuine tech failures reported promptly are the one thing that gets re-issued; running out of time is not).

Labels: **OFFICIAL** = HSBC or the platform vendor · **CORROBORATED** = multiple independent sources · **INFERRED** = coaching/reasoning. Numbered citations at the end.

1. What company runs this? (asymmetry, removed)

Cappfinity — a British assessment company (founded 2005) whose speciality is *strengths-based* hiring assessments. Your own invite proves it: the assessment link is on `apitake.cappassessments.com` and the "Candidate Zone" is `hsbc.preparationplus.com` — **both are Cappfinity-owned domains** **OFFICIAL** ^[1]. (Prep sites that say "HireVue" are describing HSBC's older setup — wrong for your stage.)

Why this matters for how you play it: Cappfinity does **not** mark most of this like a right/wrong test. It builds a **profile** — your strengths, judgement, communication — and compares it against a **"success profile"** for this specific role **CORROBORATED** ^[2]. And the success profile is public: the job posting's five traits — *curious, team player, problem-solver, detail-focused, analytical* — plus HSBC's four values. Everything you record is evidence for or against those. **[Deep dive: `hsbc-job-simulation-playbook.pdf`]**

The shape of the sitting **CORROBORATED** ^{[3][4]}: ~15 items across ~4 "tiles" that unlock in order — a camera/mic **warm-up**, a news-article scenario, a fictional-company analysis, and a final exercise with video answers plus a **typed email**. **3–5 recorded video questions, ~2 minutes to prepare, up to ~2 minutes to answer, one take each**. Not timed overall (~30 minutes typical, per your invite) — but **the time you take is recorded** and can inform the decision, so steady pace, no marathon pauses. Calculator, pen and paper on the desk (your invite says so — expect some data reading). **[Predicted questions, tier by tier: `hsbc-question-predictions.pdf`]**

2. The monitoring and anti-cheating measures — all of them

Cappfinity markets a "**multi-layer defence**" against cheating **OFFICIAL** ^[5]. Here is each layer, what it watches, and — since you're an honest candidate — the innocent behaviour that could *accidentally* look bad, with the fix. **Nothing here is about defeating detection; it's about not tripping it while playing it straight.**

Layer	What it does	Accidental trigger → the fix
Camera-On recording OFFICIAL ^[5]	Records you via webcam during video answers; a human can review the footage	Eyes darting off-screen (reading notes), another face or voice in the room, silhouette lighting → sit alone, light from the front, glance at notes only briefly, speak to the lens
Copy-prevention OFFICIAL ^[5]	Blocks/flags pasting into written answers	Drafting your email elsewhere and pasting it → type the email live in the box
Time recording CORROBORATED ^[2]	Logs time per item and overall	Implausibly instant answers (looks pre-fed) or hour-long gaps mid-tile → natural pace; complete each tile in one sitting; break between tiles
AI-use flagging (Integrity Dashboard) OFFICIAL ^[5]	Flags response patterns "indicative of AI model use" in written and spoken answers	Over-polished, generic, boilerplate text — <i>even if you wrote it</i> → your own voice, specific personal examples, natural imperfection
Consistency / authenticity checks CORROBORATED ^[2]	The same strengths are probed multiple ways (including "what would you do" vs "what would you enjoy"); contradictions are flagged	Answering personality items as the "ideal banker" instead of as yourself → honest, consistent answers; they beat a faked perfect profile on this platform
Device/connection logging INFERRED — standard for the platform class	Session metadata	VPN on, switching devices mid-way → home Wi-Fi, no VPN, one laptop start to finish

What HSBC's rules actually permit and prohibit — your invite's AI line, decoded from HSBC's official policy **OFFICIAL** ^[6]: AI for **support** is explicitly fine — research, rehearsing answers,

organising your thoughts (all of which you've done, by the book). What's prohibited: using AI to **"generate responses during live or recorded interviews"**, fabricating experience, or submitting anything you **"cannot personally explain, validate, or replicate if asked."** Practical translation: everything you say on camera and type in the email must be **your own words, produced live**. The consequence of crossing the line is withdrawal — and Cappfinity keeps integrity records. You have zero need to go near it: your prepared *structures* are legitimate and better. **[Full section: [hsbc-job-simulation-playbook.pdf](#) §6]**

3. The camera question — yes, look at the lens

Direct answer: **look at the camera lens, not at your own face on screen**. That's HSBC's own instruction, verbatim: *"Look directly at the camera and avoid looking at yourself on screen, imagine the interviewer who will be reviewing this video is there and you are talking to that person"*

OFFICIAL ^[7].

The practical set-up (do all of this in the warm-up tile, which you can redo until it's right **OFFICIAL** ^[8]): - **Camera at eye level** — prop the laptop up; looking down into a camera reads badly. - **Light in front of you** (window or lamp facing you), never behind. - Face and shoulders in frame, about an arm's length back; tidy, neutral background. - **Glancing at the on-screen question or your bullet notes is fine** — put them right next to the webcam so your eyeline barely moves. Sustained reading is what looks wrong, not a glance. - Notifications off, phone away, door shut, charged or plugged in. - Dress as your invite suggests — smart shirt; it also switches your brain on. - One myth to ignore: claims of "AI facial-expression scoring" trace to the old HireVue setup, not Cappfinity — **don't perform expressions; be warm and communicate clearly** **CORROBORATED** -flagged ^[3].

4. How your video answers are actually assessed

Who watches: Cappfinity's platform offers "AI-assisted scoring... or human-led evaluation" — but HSBC's governing statement is unambiguous: **"the AI-based platform does not make any automated decisions... all decisions will be made by our hiring team"** **OFFICIAL** ^{[6][9]}. So assume a **human reviewer** watches you, possibly with algorithmic assistance flagging and structuring — scoring against structured criteria, not vibes.

What they're weighing, in order **CORROBORATED** /INFERRED ^{[2][6]}: 1. **Content** — did you actually answer the question, with a real, specific example? (The dominant factor.) 2. **Structure** — a beginning, middle and end; point first. (This is what "communication skills" in your invite means.) 3.

Delivery — clarity, steady pace, minimal filler; calm, warm presence. 4. **Values and motivation fit** — evidence of HSBC's four values and the posting's five traits. 5. **Authenticity and consistency** — natural, first-person, consistent with your other answers across the assessment.

What sinks people **CORROBORATED** ^{[3][4]}: rambling with no structure · not answering the actual question · scripted-sounding recitation · generic answers with no personal specifics · running past the timer without landing the point · weak set-up (audio/lighting) making everything harder to credit.

5. How to pass — the strategy, condensed to one page

Everything from the library, compressed **INFERRED** — full versions in the cited docs:

The two-sentence strategy. *Be accurate and steady on anything with data; be genuinely, consistently yourself on everything behavioural; and give every video answer a spine — point first, one real example, land the close by ninety seconds.* You cannot game a strengths platform, and you don't need to — your preparation advantage is real.

Your five prepared weapons (all built, all legitimate): 1. **The 15-second contents section** for the motivation question — a named deal (the Calvin Klein supplier programme), one structural term, one number (62% of revenue from multi-country clients). (*hsbc-why-from-first-principles.pdf* §B2) 2. **The decoder** for any unpredicted question: which of the five probes is this → pick one story from your bank → 4-beat skeleton. (*hsbc-question-playbook.pdf* Part 1) 3. **The story bank** — your true stories (Head Boy, Oakwood pitch, Pictet market openings, Box cross-team plans), each tagged to a value. (*hsbc-question-playbook.pdf* ; CV mapping in *hsbc-insight-day-decoded.pdf*) 4. **The Tier-1 predictions** — intro, why-HSBC/programme, new-team, how-you'd-start-the-research, rankings, the email. If you rehearse only six things, these are the six. (*hsbc-question-predictions.pdf* Part 3) 5. **The email formula** — acknowledge → triage with a stated "why first" → recommend from the given data → own the next step. Typed live, tight, professional. (*hsbc-question-playbook.pdf* Part 6)

Per-item tactics: video — 4 bullets in prep, speak within seconds, done by ~1:40; rankings — best and worst first by the values, then the middle, don't re-litigate; personality sliders — fast and honest; email — ~8–10 minutes, one proofread.

Rehearse structures, never scripts. One take + human review + authenticity checks = the candidate who knows the *shape* and speaks fresh words wins over the one reciting. Record yourself once from bullets tonight; redo the worst answer once; stop.

6. Your 4-day runbook

- **Today:** re-read this sheet + skim your Tier-1 predicted answers. Fill anything missing in the story bank. Register on hsbc.preparationplus.com and run its practice material in the real interface.
 - **Tomorrow:** dress rehearsal — record intro, why-HSBC, new-team and one research-approach answer on your phone, one take each, from bullets. Ten-minute timed email drill, typed. Fix set-up (camera height, front light, audio).
 - **Day 3 — SIT IT.** Mid-morning, fresh. Quiet room, home Wi-Fi, laptop only, calculator + pen + paper, notifications off. Do the warm-up properly (re-record until sound and framing are right — allowed [\[8\]](#)). Then trust the structure and let it be imperfect — imperfect is what authentic sounds like.
 - **Day 4:** buffer. Only needed if something went wrong technically — report any genuine failure to emergingtalent.UK@hsbc.com immediately.
-

The library (what each document covers)

Document	What's inside
<code>hsbc-job-simulation-playbook.pdf</code>	The full deep-dive: process end-to-end, scoring model, screen-outs, integrity, AI rules, CIB context
<code>hsbc-video-interview-playbook.pdf</code>	Video-only: mechanics, camera, delivery technique, question bank, answer frameworks
<code>hsbc-question-predictions.pdf</code>	Your specific sitting: counts, timings, tiered question predictions, countdown plan
<code>hsbc-question-playbook.pdf</code>	Every question type broken down + the decoder + the email formula
<code>hsbc-why-from-first-principles.pdf</code>	Your two "why HSBC" reasons with diagrams + the 15-second contents section + humour
<code>hsbc-why-three-reasons-deals.pdf</code>	The named deals behind your reasons, with delivery guidance
<code>hsbc-insight-day-decoded.pdf</code>	The event itself + your CV mapped to their business (the Pictet golden thread)
<code>hsbc-firm-deep-dive.pdf</code> / <code>hsbc-cib-explained-simply.pdf</code> / <code>hsbc-relationship-manager-explained.pdf</code>	The firm, the division, and the role — your knowledge base

Source list (condensed — full lists in the library documents)

1. Your invite's own links: apitake.cappassessments.com and hsbc.preparationplus.com (Cappfinity-owned domains); Cappfinity practice demo — <https://practice.cappassessments.com/>
2. Cappfinity methodology — success-profile scoring, time recording, consistency checks — <https://www.intervyo.co.uk/assessments/cappfinity> and Cappfinity's *Scientific Origins of Skills & Strengths* whitepaper

3. GraduatesFirst / JobTestPrep — HSBC Job Simulation structure (3–5 videos; 2 min prep / 2 min record; email task) — <https://www.graduatesfirst.com/hsbc-job-simulation> · <https://www.jobtestprep.co.uk/hsbc-assessment-centre>
4. Psychometric Success — HSBC Online Job Simulation (~15 items; exercise structure) — <https://psychometric-success.com/aptitude-tests/test-types/hsbc-online-job-simulation>
5. Cappfinity — integrity features (Camera-On, Copy Prevention, Time-Recorded, Integrity Dashboard incl. AI-use flagging) — <https://cappfinity.com/integrity-features/>
6. HSBC — Application hints and tips (AI-use boundaries; "no automated decisions... all decisions by our hiring team"; STAR) — <https://www.hsbc.com/careers/application-hints-and-tips>
7. HSBC — On-Demand Video Interviewing Hints & Tips for Candidates (the look-at-the-camera instruction, verbatim) — <https://www.hsbc.com/-/files/hsbc/careers/pdf/on-demand-video-interviewing-hints-tips-candidates.pdf>
8. Cappfinity help desk — warm-up re-recordable; assessed answers one take — <https://capphelpdesk.zendesk.com/hc/en-us/articles/4402640631953-Will-I-be-able-to-re-record-a-video-response>
9. Cappfinity — Video Interview product ("AI-assisted scoring... or human-led evaluation") — <https://cappfinity.com/solutions/for-talent-leaders/assessments/video-interview/>

Compiled 16 August 2026 as the consolidated answer sheet for your sitting. The deadline estimate (≈20 August) is calculated from your invite's date and 10-day window — verify the exact cut-off in the assessment portal itself, and don't run it to the wire.

Self-contained briefing · rendered from `hsbc-assessment-briefing.md` · 8 August 2026. Reliability labels reflect the evidence at that date; HSBC's process changes frequently.